

JSON Translation Editor

User Guide

Version 1

A guide for translators using the JSON Translation Editor
to review, edit, and manage localization strings.

Contents

1. Getting Started
2. The Main Window
3. Filtering and Searching
4. Editing a Translation
5. Auto-Translation and the Glossary
6. Autosave and Backup
7. File Properties
8. Export and Import
9. Syncing Keys and New Languages
10. Keyboard Shortcuts
11. Customizing the App
12. Troubleshooting

1. Getting Started

The JSON Translation Editor is a desktop tool for reviewing and editing the text strings in a JSON language file. Each file is one flat JSON object: the key is the source string (usually English) and the value is its translation. The editor adds a status (New, Review, or Complete), the name of the translator, and the date of the last change to every string.

Those three things cannot live in the JSON without changing what your program reads, so they are kept in a small companion file with the same name plus `.meta` — `es.json` has `es.json.meta`. The language file is written back exactly the way it was found (indent, line endings, accents), so only the strings you changed differ. A file with no `.meta` opens with every string New.

When you launch the app, it asks for your name. This is used only to fill in the Translator field automatically when you change a translation — it is never written anywhere else and is forgotten when you close the app. Click **Skip** if you would rather not enter one. You can set or change the name at any time with **View → Set Translator Name...**, and the startup question can be switched off under **View → Translation Settings...** (“Skip translator name prompt on startup”).

With no file open, you will see the Welcome screen:

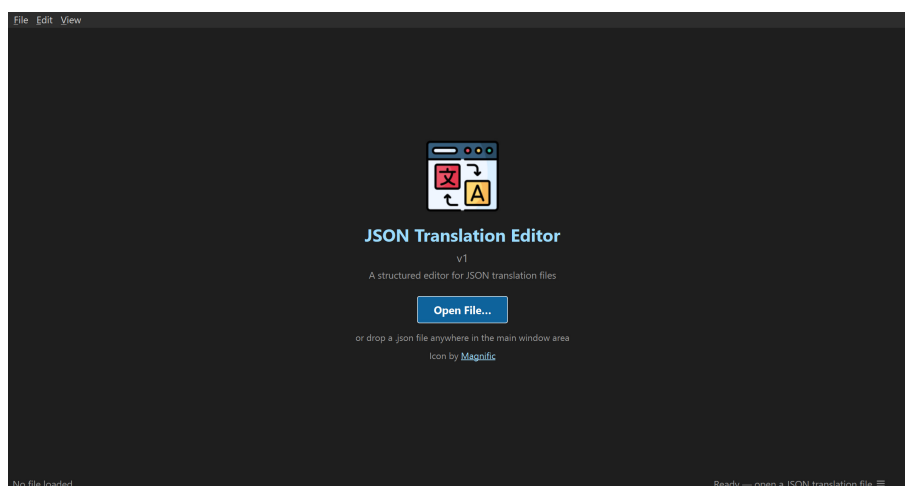


Figure 1 — The Welcome screen, shown when no file is open.

Click **Open File...**, use **File → Open... (Ctrl+O)**, or simply drag a **.json** file onto the window to open it. The app also remembers the last folder you opened a file from. **File → Close File (Ctrl+W)** returns to the Welcome screen without quitting; if there are unsaved changes you can Save, Discard or Cancel.

The **File** menu is grouped by what the commands do:

Group	Commands
Start	Open..., New Language... (section 9)
Save and go back	Save, Save As..., Restore from Backup... (section 6)
Content in and out	Import..., Export... (section 8), Sync Keys from File... (section 9)
About the file	Properties... (section 7)
Finish	Close File, Exit

2. The Main Window

Once a file is open, the window shows the filter panel, the table of strings, and an information bar at the bottom:

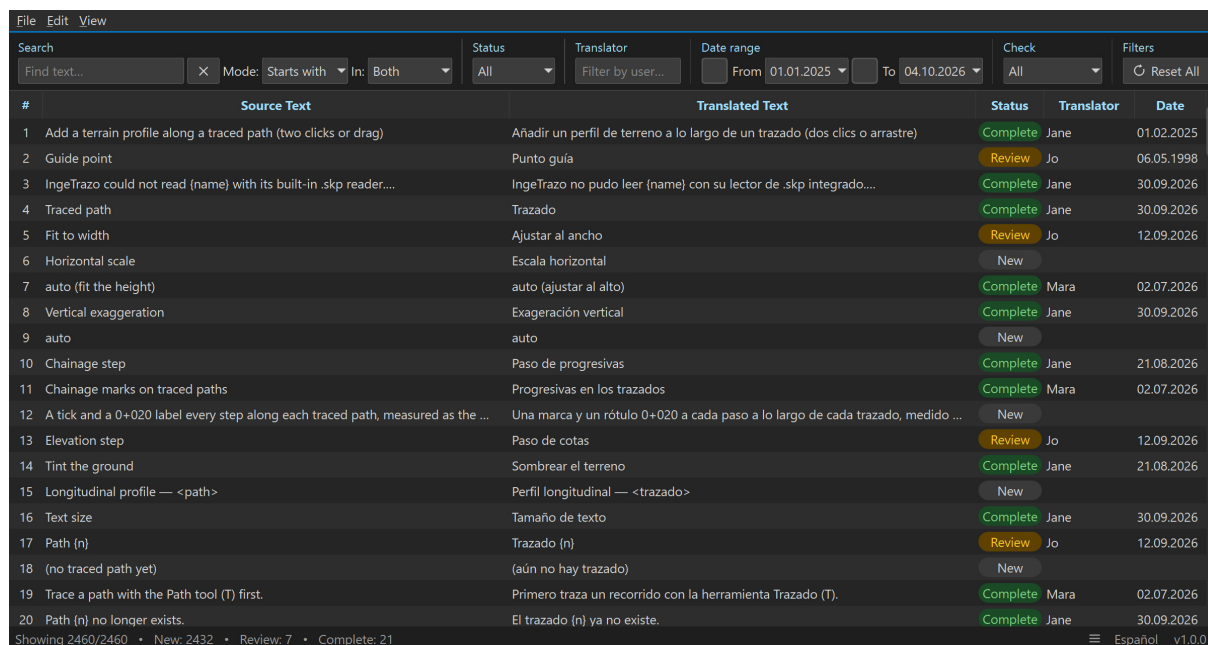


Figure 2 — The main window: filter panel, translation table, and information bar.

The table has one row per string in the file:

Column	Description
#	The string's position in the language file. Stays fixed even when a filter hides other rows.
Source Text	The original text, shown for reference. Read-only.
Translated Text	The translation, as it will be saved.
Status	New, Review, or Complete — shown as a coloured pill.
Translator	Who (or which auto-translation engine) last changed the row.
Date	When the row was last changed.

Right-click a row for quick status changes and **Delete Selected**. The title bar shows a ● while there are unsaved changes.

The information bar. From left to right it shows:

Part	What it shows
Counts	How many rows are visible out of the total, and how many are in Review and Complete.
F5 — Refresh Filter	Appears while a filter is active, as a reminder to refresh the list after edits so it reflects any status changes.
Messages	Short messages such as <i>Loaded</i> , <i>Saved</i> , <i>Autosaved</i> or <i>Backup</i> . Messages that arrive together are shown one after another, with a dim +N while more are waiting. Warnings are amber and errors red. With no message showing, the save status appears instead: <i>Unsaved changes</i> in amber or <i>Autosaved at HH:MM:SS</i> in green.
Message history	The small list button next to the messages. A dot on it marks a warning (amber) or error (red) you haven't looked at yet.
Language · Version	The file's language name and version, always at the far right.

Click the message history button to see every message of this session, newest first, with the time. Text can be selected and copied; Escape or a click outside closes it.

```
10:29:47 Backup in root: saved at 10:29:47 (compressed, +metadata, +glossary)
10:29:47 Backup next to file: saved at 10:29:47 (compressed, +metadata, +glossary)
10:29:47 Loaded: esjson v1.0.0 (2460 strings)
10:29:47 Ready — open a JSON translation file
```

Figure 3 — The message history, opened from the information bar.

Messages about a file name the file and its version, for example *Loaded: esjson v1.0.0 (2460 strings)*. If the `.meta` file has a problem (a damaged file, an entry for a string that is no longer there), the app says so in amber or red when the file is opened.

3. Filtering and Searching

The filter panel at the top narrows down the table in real time. All the filters apply together:

Filter	What it does
Search	Free-text search across the source, the translation, or both (the In: dropdown).
Status	Show only New, Review, Complete, or everything.
Translator	Show only rows changed by a particular person or engine (partial match).
Date range	Show only rows changed within a date range — tick From and/or To to use each bound.
Check	Show only strings whose <code>{{placeholders}}</code> differ between the source and the translation.

Search modes. The **Mode** dropdown next to the search box controls how your search text is matched:

- **Starts with** (the default) matches whole words that begin with what you typed. Searching "tab" finds "Tablet" or "data-tablet", but not "database".
- **Contains** matches your text anywhere — searching "tab" also finds "database".

Both modes ignore upper/lower case, and the chosen mode and field are remembered for next time. Use the **Reset All** button to clear every filter at once. An active filter is marked with an accent border on its field and a small dot after its caption, so it's always clear at a glance what is currently narrowing the table. If a filter matches nothing, the table area shows "No entries match your filter" instead of an empty grid.

Picking a date. Click a date field (or press Enter or Space on it) to open a small pop-up of scrolling columns, like a phone's date wheel:

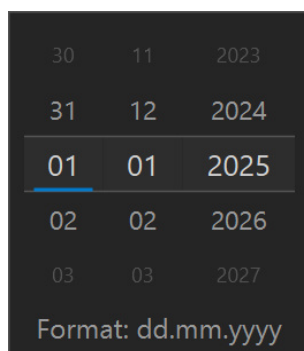


Figure 4 — The date pop-up.

Scroll or drag each column, or use the arrow keys, then press **Enter** or click the highlighted middle row to apply the date. **Escape** or a click outside closes the pop-up without changing anything. The line under the columns shows the date format in use, and the columns follow the same order. The mouse wheel and keys do nothing on the closed field, so a date can never change by accident. The Edit window's Date field works the same way.

4. Editing a Translation

Double-clicking a row (or selecting it and pressing Enter) opens the Edit window:

Source Text (read-only)

Path {n}

Translated Text

Trazado {m}

 Auto-translate

Source: 8 · Translated: 11 (+3)

Missing: {n} · Extra: {m}

Metadata

Status: Review Translator: Jo Date: 12.09.2026

 When Translated Text is changed, Status is set to Complete and Date to today automatically.

◀ 17 / 2460 ▶ Save Cancel

Figure 5 — The Edit window, showing source text, translation, and metadata.

The **Source Text** box is read-only, shown purely for reference. Type your translation into the **Translated Text** box below it. Pasted text is always inserted as plain text, with spaces at the start and end trimmed; if the source itself starts or ends with a space, the line under the box tells you the paste lost it.

The Source Text box is tall enough to show a source of up to six lines in full; a longer one scrolls. Drag the window taller or wider and both boxes grow with it.

The small counter on the right (*Source: N · Translated: M*) turns amber, then red, if your translation runs noticeably longer than the source — a useful early warning for interfaces with limited space, like buttons.

The **Status**, **Translator** and **Date** fields make up the metadata row underneath.

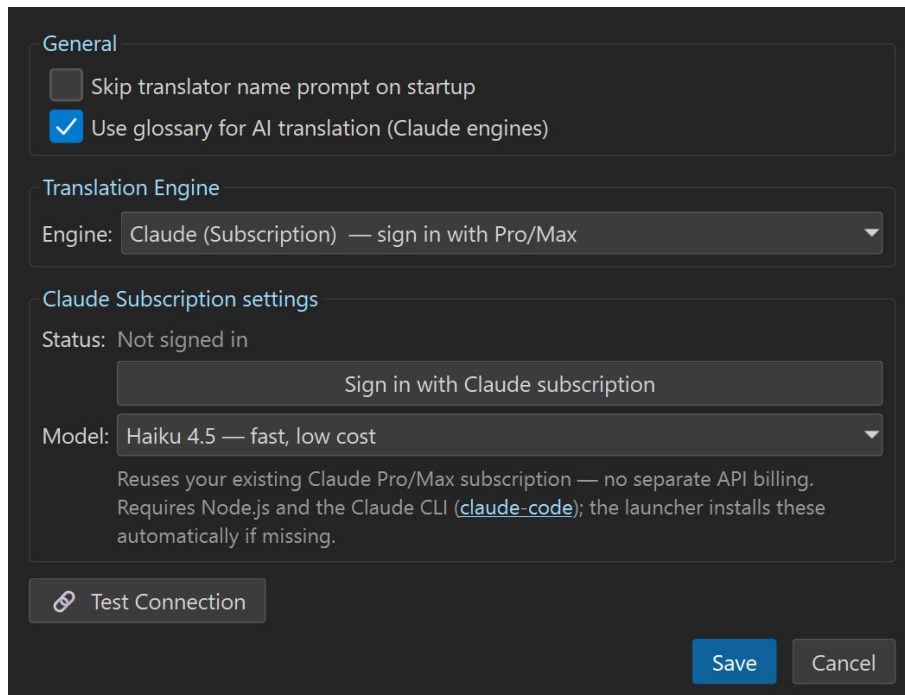
Many strings contain {placeholders} such as {name} that the program fills in later. If the translation drops or misspells one, an amber line under the text box says what is missing or extra (*Missing: {n} · Extra: {m}*, as in the figure). It never blocks saving; the filter bar's **Check** filter lists every affected string.

As soon as you change the translated text, the app automatically sets the status to **Complete**, stamps today's date, and fills in the Translator field with your session name. To record a different name, tick the **Override** checkbox next to the Translator field (it ticks itself when you type another name there). If you only change the metadata (for example, marking a row Review without touching the text), those fields are saved exactly as you set them. If nothing changed, nothing is written.

Use **Alt+Left** / **Alt+Right** to move to the previous or next row without leaving the Edit window — each step saves the current row first — or **Ctrl+Delete** (with focus outside the text fields) to remove the row you're currently editing. Deleting, here or in the main table, always asks for confirmation and, like every edit, is only written to disk when you save.

5. Auto-Translation and the Glossary

The **Auto-translate** button in the Edit window sends the source text to a translation engine and fills the result into the Translated Text box for you to review and adjust — it never saves automatically. The target language is the file's language code (from its `.meta` file, or guessed from the file name, so `pt-BR.json` is `pt-BR`). Choose an engine under **View** → **Translation Settings...**:



General

☐ Skip translator name prompt on startup

☒ Use glossary for AI translation (Claude engines)

Translation Engine

Engine: Claude (Subscription) — sign in with Pro/Max

Claude Subscription settings

Status: Not signed in

Sign in with Claude subscription

Model: Haiku 4.5 — fast, low cost

Reuses your existing Claude Pro/Max subscription — no separate API billing.
Requires Node.js and the Claude CLI ([claude-code](#)); the launcher installs these automatically if missing.

Test Connection

Save Cancel

Figure 6 — The Translation Settings dialog.

Engine	Notes
Claude / Claude (Subscription)	Best quality; understands UI context and placeholders. Choose a model: Haiku 4.5 (fast, low cost), Sonnet 5 or Opus 5. The Subscription option reuses a Claude Pro/Max sign-in instead of a paid API key.
DeepL	Excellent quality; needs a free or paid API key.
Google Translate	Good quality, free, no setup required.
MyMemory	Good quality, free, small daily limit (larger with an email address).
LibreTranslate / Microsoft Translator	Good to excellent quality; need a server URL or API key respectively.

Click **Test Connection** to translate the word "Hello" with the values as currently entered, before saving them.

Robo-Translate. Shift-click the Auto-translate button (or press **Shift+Alt+A**) to translate the current row, wait a few seconds, move to the next untouched row, and repeat automatically — handy for clearing a long list of new strings. Only rows that are New and still show the source text as their translation are filled in; anything already translated is skipped. Stop it at any time by pressing the same shortcut again, or Escape. The delay is set under **View** → **Keyboard Shortcuts...**

The Glossary. Some words need a specific, consistent translation that a general engine would not know to use — brand names, or terms specific to your product. Open **View** → **Glossary...** to maintain a list of terms and their required translations for this file:

Terms here guide AI translation for this file's Claude engines only. Matching is case-insensitive, whole word/phrase.

Term	Translation	Note
Lane	Carril	road lane
Path	Trazado	not 'ruta'
Guide point	Punto guía	

Add Row
Duplicate Row
Remove Selected Row
Save
Cancel

Figure 7 — The Glossary editor for the currently open file.

Whenever a source string contains a glossary term, that translation is passed along with the request so the Claude engines use your required wording instead of guessing. A regular English plural is matched too, so a "Lane" entry also covers "Lanes". This only affects the Claude and Claude (Subscription) engines, which are the only ones that accept this kind of extra context; it can be switched off in Translation Settings.

The glossary is saved as **<file name>.glossary.csv** next to the language file, so it can also be edited in Excel or Notepad. Files saved by Excel with a semicolon separator or a non-UTF-8 encoding are recognized, and the Glossary window explains any correction before you save.

6. Autosave and Backup

Autosave periodically saves your open file automatically, so a crash or an accidental close never costs you more than a few minutes of work. Turn it on and choose an interval under **View** → **Autosave & Backup...**:

Autosave

☐ Enable autosave

Interval: 5 minutes

Saves silently to the current file (same as Ctrl+S)

Session Backup

☒ Create backup when a file is opened

Keep last: 5 backups

Skip if backed up within: 5 minutes

☒ Compress backups (.json.gz) — saves ~70% disk space

Backup location: Next to file + Root (recommended)

☐ Restore glossary by default when restoring a backup

Location: JSON_Translation_file_Backups / <filename> / <date-time> /
Root: next to the app, or next to the file (or both) — see dropdown above.

Save Cancel

Figure 8 — The Autosave & Backup settings dialog.

Backup keeps timestamped, compressed copies of a file every time it is opened — completely separate from autosave. **Backup location** chooses where they are kept: next to the language file, in the editor's own folder, or both (the default — each place keeps its own complete history). **Keep last** sets how many copies are kept per file, and **Skip if backed up within** avoids a second copy when the file was backed up only minutes ago (set it to 0, "Always back up", to back up on every open). The information bar reports each location on its own line.

To go back to an earlier version, use **File → Restore from Backup...**:

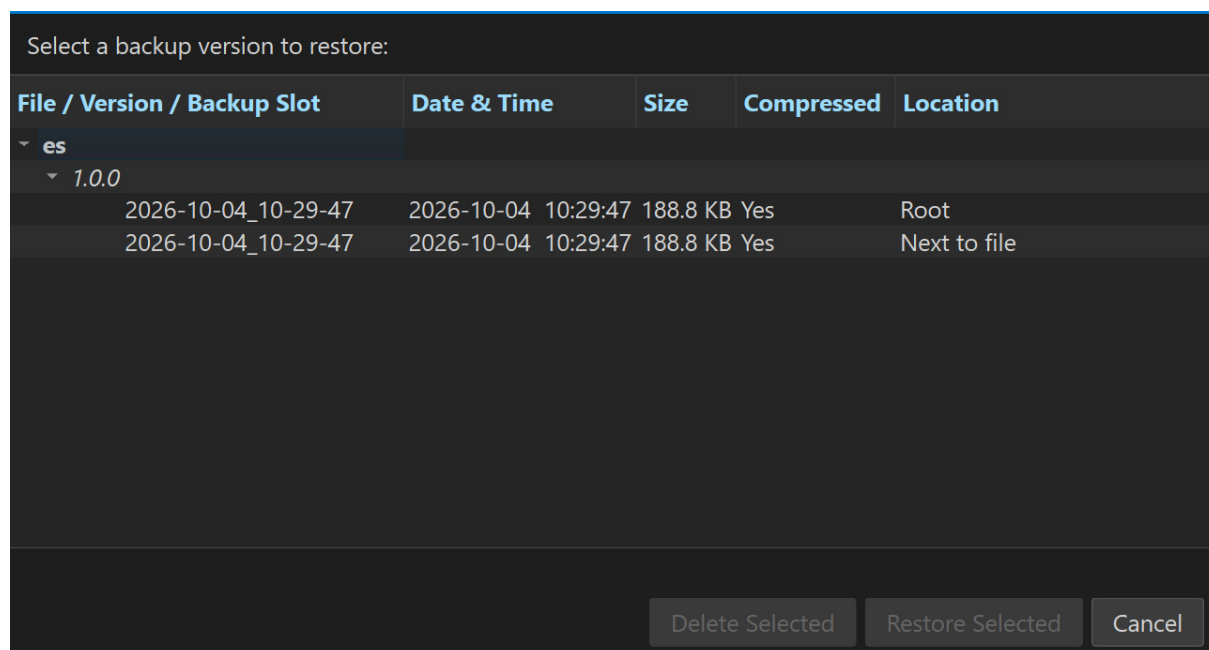


Figure 9 — Restore from Backup: backups grouped by file and version.

Select a backup and click **Restore Selected**, then choose to overwrite the original file or save a copy beside it. A safety backup of the current file is always taken automatically before a restore overwrites anything, so restoring the wrong snapshot by mistake is never a dead end. If the backup includes the file's glossary, tick **Also restore glossary** to restore it too. The file's `.meta` file is backed up and restored together with the language file, so statuses always match the translations. **Delete Selected** removes a backup you no longer need, after a confirmation.

7. File Properties

File → Properties... shows the open file's language details and a few facts about it. They are stored in its `.meta` file:

Header	
Language code:	es Spanish
Language name:	Español
Version:	1 . 0 . 0

About this file	
File:	es.json
Folder:	C:\Translations
Size:	188,8 kB
Modified:	04.10.2026 10:29
Strings:	2460
New:	2432 (98,9%)
Review:	7 (0,3%)
Complete:	21 (0,9%)
Untranslated:	38 (1,5%)

Figure 10 — The File Properties dialog.

- **Language code** — e.g. **es** or **es-AR**, with the language in words beside it. It is the target language for auto-translation. A code guessed from the file name is shown here and stored only if you change it.
- **Language name** — the name shown in the information bar, e.g. *Español*. Required, up to 64 characters. If the file has none yet, it is filled in from the code in the language's own words (**it** gives *Italiano*, **es-AR** *Español (Argentina)*) and follows the code as you change it, until you type a name of your own. A name you typed or one already stored is never replaced.
- **Version** — three boxes, e.g. 1 . 0 . 0. Use the arrows, the mouse wheel, or type the numbers; pressing . (or the keypad's decimal key) moves to the next box. The version is optional: **0 . 0 . 0** means no version, and is what a file without one shows.
- **About this file** — file name, folder, size, last change, the number of strings, how many are New, Review and Complete, how many are still untranslated. The counts include unsaved changes.

OK applies the changes like any other edit; save the file to keep them (only the `.meta` file changes).

Backups are grouped by version, so after a version change the next backup starts a new group in Restore from Backup.

8. Export and Import

To hand a translation to someone else, move it to another computer or deliver it to the program that uses it, use **File** → **Export...** A small window asks which:

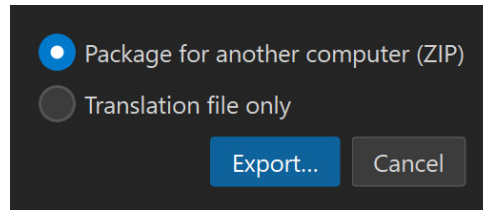


Figure 11 — Choosing what to export.

- **Package for another computer (ZIP)** (the default) — the language file, its `.meta` file and its glossary, whichever exist, in one ZIP named like `es_v1.0.0_2026-10-02.zip`. The ZIP also holds a small `export_info.json` with each file's size and checksum, so Import can tell whether anything changed on the way.
- **Translation file only** — just `es.json`, for the program that reads it.

Export takes the files from disk, so with unsaved changes you are asked to save first. Your choice and the folder are remembered for next time, and the information bar says what was written, for example *Exported: es_v1.0.0_2026-10-02.zip (3 files)*.

Import. **File** → **Import...** brings such a package back in, or a plain `.json` with its `.meta` and glossary beside it. Before anything is changed:

- A ZIP may hold only the one language file, its `.meta`, its glossary and `export_info.json` (at most 10 MB). Anything else is refused as *Not a translation package*, and nothing is written.
- If a file's checksum does not match, you are asked whether to import anyway (**No** is the default). A ZIP without checksums is imported with a note that the files were not verified.

Where it goes. If the open file has the same language, the import is merged into it (below). Otherwise you pick a folder: if a file of that name is already there, it is opened and the import is merged into it; if not, the package is unpacked there and opened, ready to work on. A stray `.meta` or glossary already in that folder is named in a question before it is replaced.

Reviewing a merge. Strings are matched by their source text. If the incoming file differs, the review window opens:

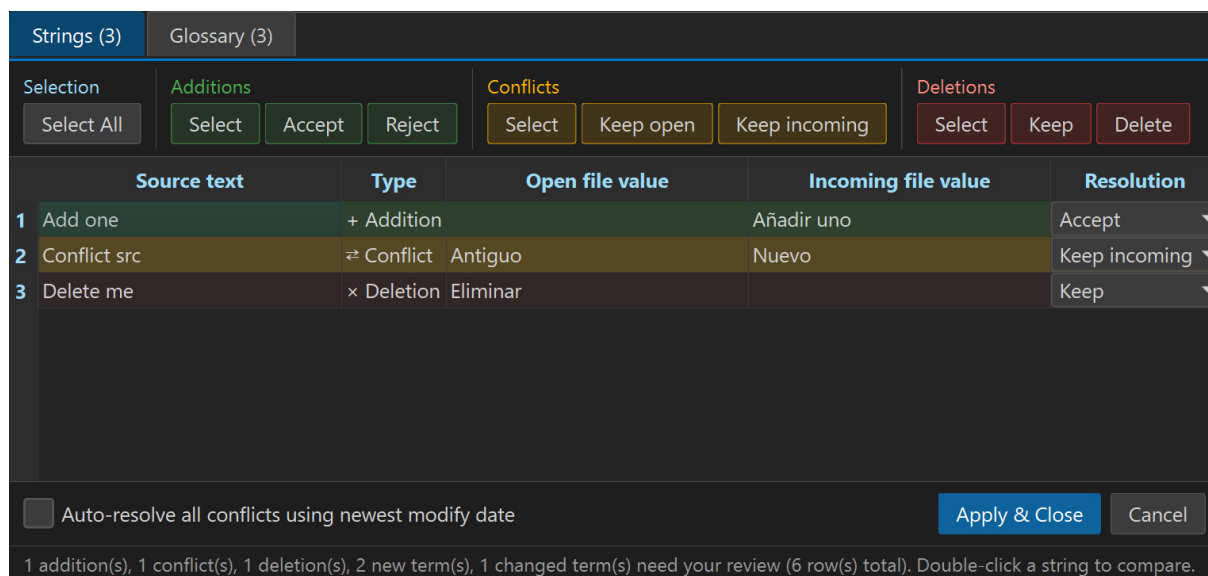


Figure 12 — Reviewing an import: an addition, a conflict and a deletion.

It sorts what it finds into three kinds of rows, each with its own Resolution dropdown:

- **Additions** — new strings found only in the incoming file. Set to **Accept** by default; switch any you don't want to **Reject**.
- **Conflicts** — the same string translated differently on each side. Choose **Keep open** or **Keep incoming** for each one; the checkbox in the footer can auto-resolve every conflict at once by whichever side was edited more recently.
- **Deletions** — a string that exists in your open file but is missing from the incoming one. Defaults to **Keep**; nothing is removed unless you explicitly switch a row to **Delete**.

Rows are tinted by their current choice: green for a string that will be added, amber for one that will change, red for one that will be deleted. The toolbar above the table selects and resolves rows of one kind at a time (for example, **Accept** every addition in one click). Rows where only the translator, status or date differ are resolved automatically using whichever side is newer — there is nothing to review for those. If nothing differs at all, the app says *Nothing to import* and no window opens.

Comparing a row. Double-click a row to see it side by side:

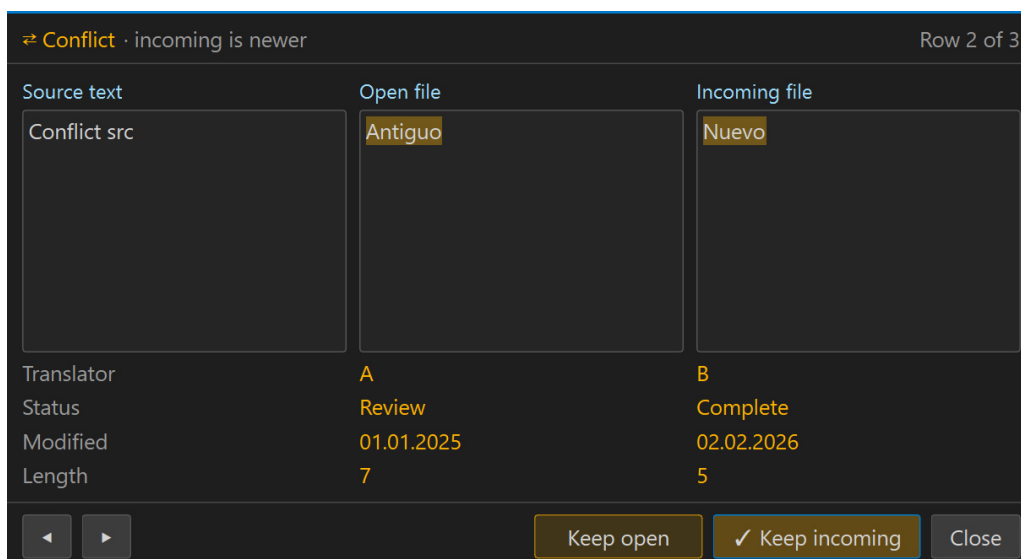


Figure 13 — Comparing one row: the words that differ are highlighted.

The pop-up shows the source text, the open file's text and the incoming file's text, with the differing words highlighted, plus translator, status, modify date and length for both sides; values that differ are amber. The header says why the default was chosen (for example, "incoming is newer"). The two buttons at the bottom resolve the row and move on to the next one; the current choice is marked with ✓, so pressing **Enter** keeps it and moves on. ◀ / ▶ (or **Alt+Left** / **Alt+Right**) step through the rows, **Alt+1** / **Alt+2** press the two buttons, and **Escape** closes the pop-up.

The Glossary tab. When the incoming glossary has terms yours lacks, or the same term with a different translation or note, a **Glossary** tab sits beside **Strings**; the tab you are on is the blue one:

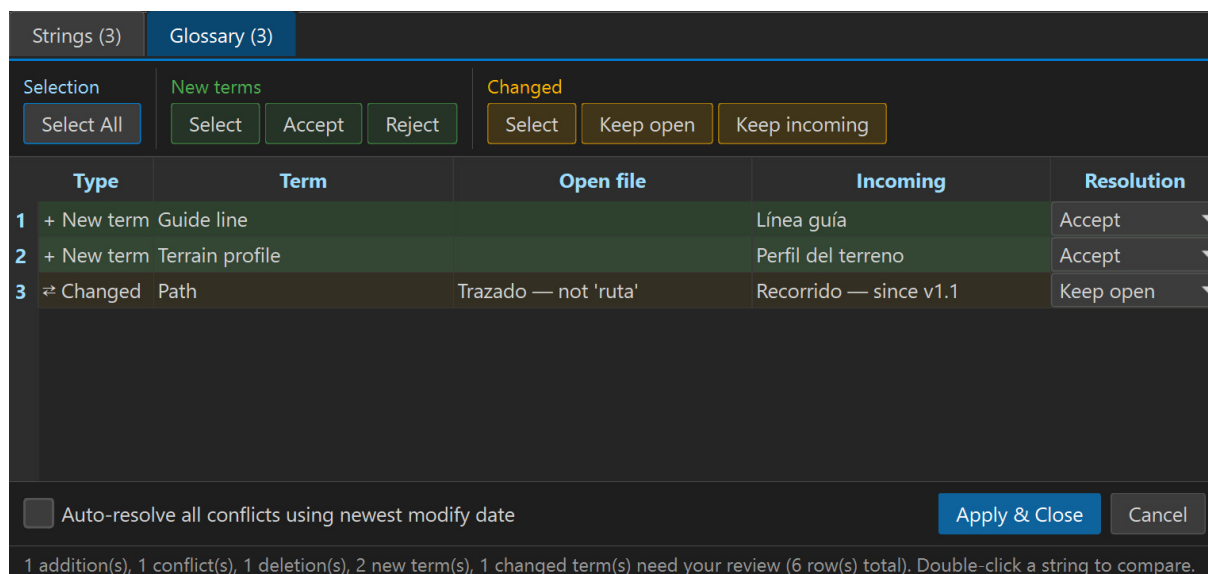


Figure 14 — The Glossary tab: new and changed terms.

New terms default to **Accept**; changed terms default to **Keep open**. Terms only in your glossary are always kept. Your glossary file is read again at this point, so terms you added in Excel since opening the file are not lost.

Click **Apply & Close** once you are happy with your choices. The glossary is written at once (*Glossary: 2 added, 1 updated*); the strings change in memory, so save the file as usual to keep them. Accepted additions go at the end of the file, and the open file keeps its own language name and version. **Cancel** leaves everything unchanged.

9. Syncing Keys and New Languages

Syncing keys. **File → Sync Keys from File...** brings your file's *keys* in line with a reference file, which can be in any language (typically the English master). Missing keys are added right after their neighbours in the reference, untranslated and New; keys the reference no longer has are offered for deletion and default to Keep. Translations are never copied or compared. The review uses the same window as Import, without the Conflicts column:

Selection

Select All

Additions

Select

Accept

Reject

Deletions

Select

Keep

Delete

	Source text	Type	Open file value	New value	Resolution
1	Fit to page	+ Addition		Fit to page	Accept
2	Delete me	× Deletion	Eliminar		Keep

Apply & Close

Cancel

1 addition(s), 1 deletion(s) need your review (2 row(s) total). Double-click a row to compare.

Figure 15 — Sync Keys: additions and deletions only.

A renamed key appears as one addition plus one deletion; nothing pairs them, so copy the old translation across by hand (a deletion row shows its current text). If the keys already match, the app says so and no window opens.

New languages. **File → New Language...** asks for a language code such as **lv** or **pt-BR**, proposes `<code>.json` beside the open file, and writes a new file with the same keys in the same order and layout, every string equal to its source and New. The new file then opens, ready to translate (Robo-Translate fills in exactly these strings). If the open file has unsaved changes, you are asked to save or discard them first; after Discard, the new file takes its keys from the file as saved on disk.

10. Keyboard Shortcuts

The Edit window and Selected Rows shortcuts below can be reassigned under **View** → **Keyboard Shortcuts...**: click **Record...**, press the new combination, or **Reset** to go back to the default.

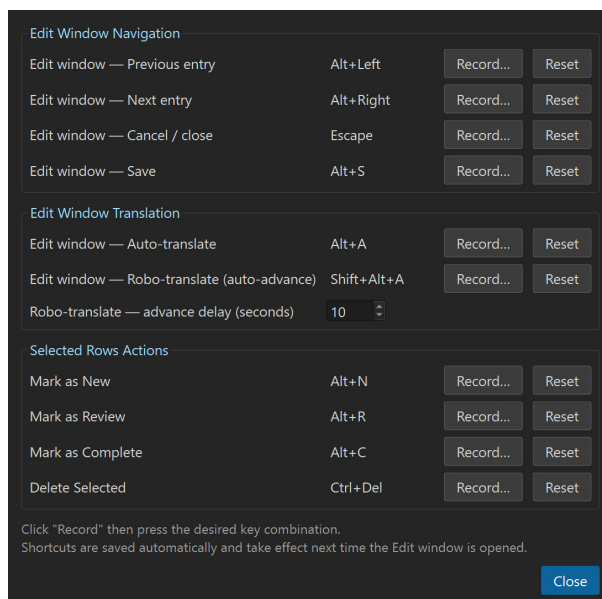


Figure 16 — The Keyboard Shortcuts dialog.

Action	Default
Open file	Ctrl+O
Save	Ctrl+S
Save As	Ctrl+Shift+S
Close file	Ctrl+W
Exit	Ctrl+Q
Edit selected row	Enter
Refresh filter	F5
Mark selected as New / Review / Complete	Alt+N / Alt+R / Alt+C
Delete selected	Ctrl+Del
Edit window: Previous / Next entry	Alt+Left / Alt+Right
Edit window: Save / Cancel	Alt+S / Escape
Edit window: Auto-translate	Alt+A
Edit window: Robo-Translate	Shift+Alt+A
Merge compare pop-up: the two choices	Alt+1 / Alt+2

11. Customizing the App

Theme. Switch between Dark and Light under **View** → **Theme**. Your choice is remembered for next time.

Font. Choose the interface font and size under **View** → **Choose UI Font...**, with a live preview of your selection. Dialogs, hints, check boxes and scrollbars grow with the chosen size:

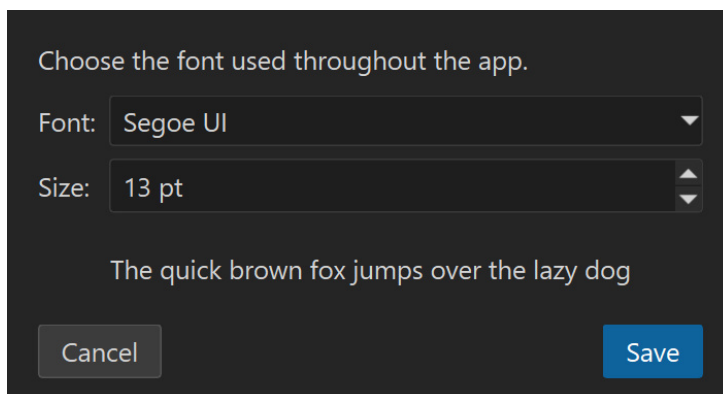


Figure 17 — The Choose UI Font dialog.

Column widths. Drag a column's edge to resize it — the new width is remembered automatically.

All of your preferences — theme, font, shortcuts, filter settings, and translation engine setup — are stored automatically in a small settings file next to the application, and do not need to be configured again after restarting.

Settings backup. Because the settings file holds your API keys, the app keeps a copy of it once a day in **json_translation_editor_settings.backups.zip** beside it (the newest 10 days). If the settings file is ever damaged, the app restores the newest good copy automatically at startup and tells you so. Deleting the settings file is still the way to reset everything to defaults.

12. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
The date picker shows the wrong format	The app follows your Windows regional date setting. Change it under Control Panel → Region → Short date, then restart the app.
Autosave shows a "File Locked" message	Another program has the file open. Choose Save As... to save a copy elsewhere, or Skip to try again at the next interval — no changes are lost either way.
No backups are being created	Check the Backup messages in the information bar or its message history: each location is reported separately, and a failed one shows in red. "Skipped..." means a recent backup already exists — lower "Skip if backed up within" under View → Autosave & Backup... if you want one every time.
A message went by too quickly	Click the message history button in the information bar to read every message of this session.
A file is refused when opened	The message names the problem: invalid JSON (with line and column), a top level that is not an object, a value that is not text, or the same key twice. Fix the file in a text editor and open it again.
"Reformat File" appears on the first save	The file's layout (indent, spacing) is not one the app reproduces exactly, so saving will tidy it. Only whitespace changes, never the translations. Answer Yes once; later saves ask nothing. Autosave waits until you have done this.
Import says "Not a translation package"	The ZIP holds a subfolder, an extra file, two language files, is over 10 MB unpacked, or is damaged. Export it again with File → Export...
Import asks about files that do not match their checksums	A file in the package changed after it was exported, or the ZIP was damaged on the way. Answer No and ask for a fresh export unless you know why it changed.
Everything shows as New	The file's <code>.meta</code> file is missing or was damaged. A damaged one is kept as <code>.meta.corrupt- <time></code> and the app says so; restore it from a backup or repair the kept copy.
A keyboard shortcut stopped working	Check its binding under View → Keyboard Shortcuts... — it may have been reassigned, or another application may be using the same combination.

Auto-translate says "No target language"

The target language is the file's language code. If the file name is not a code (for example `strings.json`), set it under **File** → **Properties....**

Google Translate says it is rate-limiting this network

Google limits how many free requests one network may send. Wait a while, raise the Robo-Translate delay, or switch to another engine in Translation Settings.

A settings recovery message appears at startup

The settings file was damaged (for example by a crash) and was restored from the newest daily copy. Check your translation settings and API keys; if no copy existed, enter them again.